

Editions of the *Suśrutasaṃhitā*

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1. **Tyler, John (1834) “Translation of two chapters of the First Part of the Soosroota”.**

The earliest known translation of any portion of the *Suśrutasaṃhitā* into a European language appears to be John Tytler’s “Translation of two chapters of the First Part of the Soosroota.” The work consists of a translation of chapters 4 and 5 of the *Sūtrasthāna*. Tytler enclosed the translation in a letter dated 29 January 1834 addressed to Captain Troyer, secretary of the Sanskrit College from 1833 to 1835. The translation is reproduced in ch.,4 Sen, S. N. (1991), “Medical and Technical Education,” in *Scientific and Technical Education in India 1781–1900* (New Delhi: Indian National Science Academy), 125–61. DOI: [10.5281/zenodo.17561581](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.17561581): 160–161.

The translation was produced in the context of debates over medical education in colonial India. Following a proposal submitted by the Sanskrit College, Calcutta, to the General Committee of Public Instruction in June 1826, medical instruction was introduced at the College under Tytler’s supervision. Students were taught both traditional Āyurvedic works, including the compendia of Caraka and Suśruta, and European medical texts. In March 1834, Captain Troyer sought Tytler’s opinion on a proposal to abandon Sanskrit medical texts altogether and teach European medicine exclusively through English textbooks. By that time, Tytler had been serving as superintendent of the School for Native Doctors since 1830. As a committed orientalist and admirer of Sanskrit and Arabic scientific literature, he

strongly opposed the proposal. The letter containing his translation of SS 1.4–5 was written only two months before this exchange.¹

2. **Gupta, Madhusudana (1835–36) (ed.),** *The Suśruta, or system of medicine, taught by Dhanwantari, and composed by his disciple Suśruta*, 2 vols. (Calcutta: Education Press; Baptist Mission Press), [ark:/13960/t6841qw6x](https://nopr.ernet.in/handle/2015/26841); Vol. I: Sutra, Nidana and Sarira (Education Press, 1835). Vol. II: Chikitsa, Kalpa and Uttara Tantra (Baptist Mission Press, 1836).

The editio princeps of the *Suśrutasaṃhitā* was published by Madhusudan Gupta, professor of medicine at the Sanskrit College, Calcutta. Gupta had also assisted John Tytler at the School for Native Doctors for two years, helping explain English medical terminology to students in Sanskrit and Bengali. The edition was published in two volumes in Devanagari script in 1835 and 1836.

Gupta did not indicate the manuscripts or other sources used in preparing the text. The edition was reprinted in four volumes in Calcutta in 1868, and a second edition in two volumes appeared in 1874.²

3. **Hessler, Franciscus (1844–55),** *Suśrutas. Ayurvédas. Id est medicinae systema a venerabili D'Hanvantare demonstratum a Suśruta discipulo compositum: Nunc primum ex Sanskrīta in Latinum sermonem vertit, introductionem, annotationes et rerum indicem*, 3 vols. (Erlanga: Ferdinandus Enke), [ark:/13960/s269znc087g](https://nopr.ernet.in/handle/2015/269znc087g).

The German physician and philologist Franz Hessler translated the *Suśrutasaṃhitā* into Latin and published the translation in three volumes in 1844, 1847, and 1850, respectively. He did not specify the edition or manuscripts on which his translation was based. It is likely that he used Madhusudan Gupta's editio princeps as the basis of his translation, although he may also have consulted manuscripts. This possibility is suggested by his announcement, at the end of the preface to the first volume, that he intended to publish a "purified Sanskrit text" (*textum Sanskrītum purgatum*) in two volumes.³ This announcement suggests that he intended to establish a revised Sanskrit text, although it does not by itself demonstrate that he had

¹See S. N. Sen 1991: 145, 151–152, 160–161.

²HIML: 1B, 311.

³Hessler 1844–55: 1, Praefatio VIII.

consulted manuscript sources. No such edition, however, was ever published. In addition to the translation, Hessler later published two volumes of notes and annotations on the *Suśrutasaṃhitā*.⁴

4. Bhaṭṭācāryya, Jīvānanda Vidyāsāgara (1873) (ed.), *Suśrutah | Sūtranidānaśarīracikitsākalpottaratantrakalpitaḥ* (1st Edition, Calcutta: Dvaipāyana Press); 2nd ed., Calcutta 1886; 3rd ed., Calcutta 1889 ([ark:/13960/t80k7t407](https://nnp.library.yale.edu/ark:/13960/t80k7t407)); 4th ed., Calcutta 1899.

Jīvānanda Vidyāsāgara Bhaṭṭācāryya published an edition of the *Suśrutasaṃhitā* in Devanagari script at Calcutta in 1873. In many of his editions, Bhaṭṭācāryya reproduced texts from earlier printed editions without acknowledging his sources. His edition of the SS is also likely taken from Gupta's editio princeps. Subsequent editions were published in 1886, 1889, and 1899.

5. Bandopadhyaya, Ombica Charana (1873–74) (ed. and trans.), *সু-শ্রুত । প্রাচীন হিন্দুদিগের চিকিৎসা বিজ্ঞান । বাঙ্গলা অনুবাদ এবং সংস্করণ Medical science of the ancient Hindoos translated and edited* (1st edition, Kalikātā: Bhikṭoriyā Yantrālaya), [ark:/13960/t4km6hz1w](https://nnp.library.yale.edu/ark:/13960/t4km6hz1w); 2nd ed., Calcutta 1885 ([ark:/13960/s2ckqqbfsk2](https://nnp.library.yale.edu/ark:/13960/s2ckqqbfsk2)).

In Śaka 1795 (1873/74 CE), Ambikā Carana Bandyopādhyāya published an edition of the *Suśrutasaṃhitā* in Bengali script together with a Bengali translation in two volumes. A second edition appeared in 1885. As in the case of Bhaṭṭācāryya's edition, no information is given regarding the sources used in establishing the text. It is likewise quite plausible that the edition ultimately derives from Gupta's editio princeps.

6. Sen, Harimohan (1880) (ed. and trans.), *Nibandha-saṃgraha by Dallana. Susruta sanhita. A system of medicine taught by Dhavanantari to his disciples. And composed by Susruta with commentary of Dallanacharya. Corrected and translated [into Bengali]: Sūtrasthāna* (Comilla: Varadeśvarī Press); HIML 1d.

[Not accessible to me.]

7. n.a. (1885), సుశ్రుతాచార్య ప్రణీతంబైన సుశ్రుతనామకాయుర్వేదాంతర్గత శారీరస్థానము

⁴Hessler 1852–55.

(Madras: Vartamāna-taraṃgiṇī Press); HIML 1e.

[Not yet accessible to me.]

8. Kaviratna, Avināśacandra (1885) (ed. and trans.), *suśrutasaṃhitā mahāmatidallanācāryyakṛtanibandhasaṃgrahākhyatikāśahitā* (Calcutta); Sūtra-, Nidāna-, and Śārīrasthāna, 1885, Sūtrasthāna and Nidānasthāna, Rāmāyaṇa Press, 1886; HIML 1f.

[Not yet accessible to me.]

9. Sena, Bijayaratna, Sena, Bhagabatiprasanna, and Sena, Niśikānta (1886–93) (eds.), *সুশ্রুত-সংহিতা ... ডল্লনাচার্য্য-কৃত-নিবন্ধ-সংগ্রহ, চক্রপাণিদত্ত-কৃত-ভানুমতী-টীকা ... বঙ্গানুবাদ ... ইংরেজি প্রতিশব্দ ... এবং শাস্ত্র-যন্ত্রাদির প্রতিকৃতি সমন্বিত*, 14 vols. (Calcutta: Maṇirāma Press); HIML 1g.

[Not yet accessible to me.] Cattoṇpādhyāya (1959:xxviii) mentions that Niśikānta Sena could not complete this edition. Cattoṇpādhyāya tried to trace the manuscript of Cakrapāṇidatta's *Bhānumatī*, which he believed was with someone in the Kumartuli area of Calcutta. But he was unsuccessful.

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